



UNOFFICIAL SUPPLEMENT

LSE FESTIVAL 2026

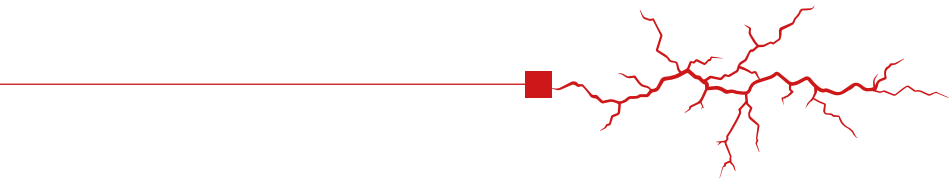
15–20 JUNE

THE ANNOTATED PROGRAMME

WHAT EACH EVENT DOESN'T MENTION —
AND WHAT THE UNIVERSITY WON'T DISCUSS

“HOW TO SAVE THE PLANET”
FREE ADMISSION
FOSSIL FUEL INVESTORS WELCOME

Welcome to the Planet-Saving Institution that Bankrolls its Destruction



This week, LSE opens its doors for a festival themed “How to Save the Planet.” It has assembled economists, academics, policy ministers, journalists, and scientists to speak about the climate crisis, green finance, and ecological governance.

But while the institution performs planetary concern on its stages, it holds more than £86 million in investments across the very industries responsible for the climate catastrophe.

As you attend this festival, remember that LSE does not put its money where its mouth is.

THE MONEY

In May 2024, LSESU's Palestine Society published *Assets in Apartheid*, 116 pages of forensic analysis of LSE's endowment. In June 2025, it published *Stakes in Settler Colonialism*, a 228-page update. The findings are unambiguous:

LSE holds **£86,648,836** in companies profiting from the extraction and/or distribution of fossil fuels, including BP (£2.05m), Enel (£1.98m), and Shell (£1.11m). Its investment advisor, JP Morgan Chase, is the world's most prolific financier of fossil fuels, according to the 2025 "Banking on Climate Chaos: Fossil Fuel Finance Report." This is who LSE trusts with its money.

Beyond fossil fuels: this university has investments worth £71,914,679 in companies profiting from the manufacture and/or proliferation of arms as well as the funding of nuclear weapons. £72,913,629 in companies profiting from the genocide in Gaza, supplying the Israeli military, operating in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, involved in illegal settlement activities, and funding the occupation of Palestine.

These are not abstract figures. Every barrel pumped, every missile shipped, and every settlement financed by a company in this portfolio is a decision that LSE's Finance and Estates Committee has taken, and refuses to reverse. For LSE, money is more important than lives. The School will happily stage a festival about saving the planet while bankrolling its destruction and, in doing so, use the spectacle of concern to obscure its own role in ecological breakdown and genocide.

OIL AND EDUCATION DON'T MIX

One company in LSE's portfolio stands out: BP (British Petroleum). LSE's relationship with BP is not a passive investment; it is a partnership. BP — the corporation behind the Deepwater Horizon disaster, responsible for spilling 134 million gallons of oil into the Gulf of Mexico — is a corporation that our university has decided to get in bed with.

But environmental destruction is only part of BP's record. As the principal owner and operator of the Baku-Tbilisi-Ceyhan (BTC) pipeline, BP supplies Israel with close to a third of the oil fuelling its genocide in Palestine and Lebanon. This oil provides the petrol in the warplanes, the diesel in the tanks, the fuel for the machinery of occupation and genocide. This is not a side effect of BP's business model. It is the business model.

Trace BP's history and this pattern of imperial complicity holds: colonial extraction and coup d'état in Iran; assistance to apartheid South Africa and Rhodesia in evading oil embargoes; plunder of the former Soviet republics in the 1990s. Today, its executives pocket multi-million-pound salaries while depriving the earth and its people of the resources necessary for survival. The company's function has never changed: extract wealth from the many and deliver it to the few, whatever the political, ecological, or moral cost.

LSE has been here before. In 1988, following a two-week student occupation of Connaught House, LSE divested from all 26 of its holdings in companies complicit in South African apartheid, a stake worth £3 million that included investments in BP. However, two years later, in 1990, LSE accepted £1.25 million from BP to establish the "BP Centennial Professorship Scheme," designed, in LSE's own words, to "contribute to the internal education programme of BP and to develop contacts between the School and BP." Under this scheme, LSE lends BP the grammar of sustainability, development, and progress. This is the precise language BP uses to greenwash its complicity in climate breakdown while the planet burns.

THE GOVERNANCE

In June 2024, the LSE Student Union (LSESU) held a referendum on divestment from fossil fuels and arms producers with 89% of students voting in favour. In February 2026, the referendum was renewed with similar overwhelming support. Both times, LSE management declined to listen to its student body, citing "fiduciary duties." Fiduciary duties describe the legal obligation to act in the financial interests of the institution. But fiduciary duty is not the neutral, technical constraint that

management presents it as. It is a choice about whose interests count and over what timescale.

The fossil fuel companies in LSE's portfolio are not profitable *despite* the ecological crisis; they are profitable *because* its costs are offloaded onto the atmosphere, the countries of the Global South, and the next generation. Rising seas, crop failure, displacement, war over water: these do not appear on their balance sheets. They appear on *ours*. The "fiduciary" case for staying invested in BP also assumes a functioning economy in which to spend the returns — and that economy requires a functioning planet. Climate scientists tell us we are running out of time before the obligation to generate returns and the obligation to inhabit a planet cease to be compatible. LSE's management has decided, twice, that this is a problem for later. The students of this institution have decided, twice, that later is now.

Furthermore, LSE's own Grantham Institute has published research demonstrating that fossil fuel divestment does not damage financial returns. This research directly undermines the fiduciary argument management keeps reaching for. The Universities of Glasgow and Cambridge have excluded fossil fuels from their investments and Trinity College Dublin and San Francisco State University have divested from the weapons and war industries. If they can do it, why can't we? LSE does not lack the evidence, the precedent, or the mandate to divest. It lacks the will.

GREENWASHING

Greenwashing is the practice of deploying the language of environmental responsibility to obscure the reality of environmental harm. It does not require lying. It requires only that the performance of concern be loud enough, and public enough, to crowd out scrutiny of the underlying conduct.

This week, LSE asks: "What can we be doing to save the Earth, its people and environment?" It hosts panels on green finance, climate law, and energy transition. It invites the first US Special Presidential Envoy for Climate. It commissions a session advising the public on how to make their personal investments work for the planet. Meanwhile,

the institution's own endowment — managed by JP Morgan Chase, the world's largest fossil fuel financier — holds £86 million in fossil fuel companies. Its TPI Centre publishes research on carbon accountability that its own investment committee ignores. Its Geography Department hosts panels on energy transition while the university holds stock in BP, a company that reversed its own net-zero commitments in 2025. The branding is impeccable. The speakers are serious. The contradiction is total.

What the Festival does not advertise is that this is not a contradiction the university has failed to notice. It is a contradiction the university has chosen to live with, and chosen, this week, to paper over with a festival. This is greenwashing.

SUMMARY

Ecocide is not abstract. It is a business model, and LSE finances it. Colonialism is not a historical metaphor. It is an ongoing structure of occupation, and LSE's portfolio funds it. The festival theme is not ironic; it is insulting. It is antithetical to host "How to Save the Planet" while the university's endowment accelerates its destruction and underwrites the fuel that powers genocide.

LSE does not take this crisis seriously in any meaningful way. The LSE Festival treats the climate catastrophe as a game, inviting attendees to simulate climate treaty negotiations as a competitive exercise — participants can "join a team of either 'nature defenders' or 'exploiters' and discover hidden roles and the art of deception in a game to save climate accords." The planet is burning. This is LSE's response.

The Programme



MONDAY 15 JUNE

DAY ONE

13:30 *The Politics of Climate Change*

A panel on the “rollback of net zero” and green backlash in politics. The rollback is real, and it is engineered by the kind of fossil capital that LSE continues to hold. LSE is its own case study: students voted for divestment in 2024, and again in 2026. Management declined to act both times. The political obstacles to net zero are not only found in Westminster; they are found in the Finance and Estates Committee of this institution.



Ask: Why did LSE override its own democratic mandate to divest from fossil fuels?

17:00 *How to Save the Planet with Mariana Mazzucato*

The festival keynote. Mazzucato’s work on mission-oriented public investment argues the state must direct capital toward collective goals rather than leaving markets to decide. But LSE’s endowment — partly funded by student fees — is channelled through JP Morgan Chase, the world’s top fossil fuel financier, and into BP, the same company whose oil pipeline fuels Israeli war crimes in Palestine. A genuine mission economy requires democratic control of capital. Here, the institution has twice overridden democratic student mandates to exercise exactly that control.



Ask: If mission-oriented policy means aligning finance with public purpose, what does it say about the purpose of this institution when it continues to fund fossil fuels and genocide?



18:00 *The Future of Refugee Integration*

A screening and panel discussion on refugee integration, hosted during Refugee Week. The connection between climate breakdown and forced displacement is well established. Climate scientists project hundreds of millions of climate refugees by mid-century. The question unasked in this session is who bears responsibility? The countries and corporations that have emitted the most — and continue to do so — are not the ones absorbing the displaced. LSE's portfolio includes the fossil fuel companies producing those emissions, and the arms manufacturers supplying the conflicts that compound displacement. Attending to refugee integration without addressing the institutions financing the causes constitutes humanitarian concern without accountability.



Ask: How can LSE speak to refugee futures while investing in the fossil fuel and arms industries that produce displacement?

18:30 *How Geoeconomics Will Affect the Green Transition*

Economists and industry analysts from LSE's Centre for Economic Performance examine how geopolitical shocks are reshaping the green transition. What goes unexamined is how institutions like the LSE contribute to them. Investments in arms and fossil fuel companies produce the conditions that shock geopolitics and stymie the green transition. The geopolitical obstacles to green transition include the investment decisions of institutions that know better.



Ask: Does geoeconomic analysis of the green transition account for the role universities play in sustaining fossil capital?

TUESDAY 16 JUNE

DAY TWO

13:00 Political Economy Analysis for Accelerating the Green Transition

A skills session on the analytical tools for understanding — and accelerating — green transition. The irony is structural: the institution hosting this session has twice been presented with a democratic mandate to accelerate its own transition away from fossil fuels, and twice declined. The political economy of green transition includes the political economy of institutional inertia. LSE is a case study in both.



Ask: What does this framework say about institutions that commission research on green transition while blocking it in their own portfolios?

13:00 Green Industrial Policy: Balancing National Goals and Global Integration

A panel on whether green industrial policy can survive political headwinds. LSE's Centre for Economic Performance co-hosts. Note: LSE's own asset manager, JP Morgan Chase, ranks 1st in financing fossil fuel expansion — not green industrial policy. The “uncertain environment” is produced, in part, by the financial flows LSE's endowment sustains. Academic expertise on green policy is structurally severed from the institution's own material choices.



Ask: Is there a firewall between CEP research on green transition and the investment committee that keeps LSE's money in fossil fuel expansion — and should there be?



17:00 Mobilising Investment for a Sustainable Planet

The President of the European Investment Bank discusses sustainable finance. Meanwhile, LSE holds £37.8 million in European financial institutions whose investee companies are listed by the UN Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights as involved in illegal Israeli settlement activities. Santander (£3.2m), Deutsche Bank (£1.6m), Barclays (£2.5m) are among them. The EIB exists to mobilise capital toward public goods; LSE's portfolio directs it toward occupation and dispossession. The sustainable finance conversation will not mention this.



Ask: The EIB has exclusion criteria for projects that violate international law. Should universities adopt similar criteria?

18:30 Wired to Save the Planet: Rethinking Energy in an Electrified World

LSE Geography and Environment hosts a panel on energy transition. The department's own researchers have documented how fossil fuel lobby financing distorts energy policy globally. BP — in LSE's portfolio — reversed its own energy transition commitments in 2025 after activist hedge fund Elliott Management demanded more oil extraction and less renewables investment. The electrified world panel is hosted by a university whose money is on the other side of this transition.



Ask: The electrified world requires capital to move away from fossil fuels. LSE's capital is moving toward them. Is the university hosting this panel impeding the energy transition?

WEDNESDAY 17 JUNE

DAY THREE

13:00 How the Right Laws Can Save the Planet

LSE Law hosts a session on legislative frameworks for climate action. Tessa Khan, a leading climate litigator, is set to speak. The same legal imagination that she has used to pursue states and corporations for climate inaction has yet to be applied to the institution convening this conversation. When a university holds investments in companies the UN has linked to war crimes and illegal occupation, and then suspends the students who act against it, does it breach its obligations under international human rights law? Two UN Special Rapporteurs have already said yes. The law panel does not discuss its own institution.



Ask: Under the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, institutions have a duty to avoid contributing to human rights abuses through their investments. Is LSE in violation of that duty?



17:00 Economic Threats: Question Time at LSE Festival

A Q&A session on the economic threats facing the planet and its people. The format invites the audience to pose the questions. Here are some worth asking.



Ask: LSE's own Grantham Institute has shown that fossil fuel divestment carries no financial penalty. Why has the institution that produced that research refused to act on it?



Ask: Climate-related financial risk is now recognised by the Bank of England, the Financial Stability Board, and the IPCC as a systemic threat to economic stability. At what point does a university's refusal to divest become a failure of its own risk management?



Ask: The fossil fuel industry's business model requires burning more carbon than the planet can absorb. At what point does continuing to invest in that model constitute malfeasance and a knowingly irrational economic decision?

THURSDAY 18 JUNE

DAY FOUR

12:00 *Make Your Money Work for the Planet*

LSE's TPI Global Climate Transition Centre tells the public how to align personal investments with climate goals. Its methodology assesses companies' alignment with the Paris Agreement. By its own benchmarks, BP's trajectory is a failure, and LSE holds BP. The Centre advises external investors on carbon performance while the university it sits within ignores the advice. This is the internal contradiction that a "green finance" framework cannot acknowledge without unravelling.



Ask: Has the TPI Centre ever been asked to apply its methodology to LSE's investments — and if not, would you support an independent assessment of this university's climate alignment?

19:00 *The Green Shoots of the New Economy*

Bloomberg Green's Akshat Rathí — who has covered fossil fuel greenwashing extensively — joins a panel asking whether business can drive real climate solutions. Rathí's own reporting has documented how BP's 2025 strategy reversal exposed the hollow nature of its previous net-zero branding. The university hosting this conversation holds BP stock and has refused to divest despite two student mandates, two research reports, and international legal criticism.



Ask Rathí: Is LSE itself a case study in institutional greenwashing?



FRIDAY 19 JUNE

DAY FIVE

13:00 *Can We Tackle Climate Change Without Deepening Inequality?*

A panel on the relationship between climate action and inequality — within and between countries. The question is important, but the framing conceals a prior one: who caused this crisis? The Global Majority has contributed least to cumulative emissions and bears the greatest burden of climate breakdown. The imperial powers (their governments, corporations, and militaries) have emitted most and continue to do so. Tackling climate change without deepening inequality requires, first, that the richest institutions in the richest countries stop financing its causes.



Ask: LSE's endowment is invested in fossil fuel companies whose extraction is concentrated in the Global South and whose profits flow to shareholders in the Global North. Does the panel consider that a form of inequality worth addressing?



18:00 Global Sustainability: In Conversation with John Kerry

The former US Climate Envoy and Secretary of State speaks on global sustainability. Under the administration he represented, the US became the world's largest oil producer, approved major new fossil fuel projects, and maintained military emissions exempt from climate accounting. The imperial contradiction — lecturing the world on decarbonisation while expanding extraction and arming occupation — is mirrored in miniature at LSE, which convenes this conversation while holding fossil fuel and arms stocks and partnering with BP. Global sustainability, spoken from a platform built on colonial and ecological violence, is not leadership; it is theatre.



Ask: Can Western states and institutions (like the USA and the LSE) credibly lead on global sustainability while their investments and foreign policies continue to finance fossil fuel expansion and military occupation?

19:00 Saving the Planet in an Age of Geopolitical Rivalry

LSE and Tsinghua scholars discuss geopolitical rivalry and its impact on climate governance. The panel treats “conflict” as an abstract planetary threat, refusing to name the active genocide in Gaza, the occupation of Palestine, or the fact that LSE's own portfolio is financially entangled with both. International cooperation on climate is a hollow proposition if it brackets out the fossil-fuelled structures of empire and settler colonialism that make the crisis uneven and criminal in its distribution.



Ask: Does it make sense to discuss climate cooperation without addressing how Western universities fund the fossil supply chains that fuel occupation and war?

SATURDAY 20 JUNE

DAY SIX

14:00 *Why Evidence Matters*

A panel on the authority of scientific evidence in policy. Both speakers represent institutions whose credibility rests on following evidence where it leads. The scientific consensus on fossil fuels is settled. LSE's own researchers contributed to the evidence base for divestment. The university's endowment remains in fossil fuels. Evidence, it appears, applies to policy advice given to others.



Ask: This panel argues that evidence should guide institutional decision-making. LSE has been presented with two research reports, two democratic mandates, and decades of scientific consensus — all pointing toward divestment. What would constitute sufficient evidence for this institution to divest from fossil fuels?

18:30 *What's it Going to Take us to Save the Planet?*

The closing event asks whether societies can cooperate across polarisation. It is the right question to end on — and the irony is precise. LSE's administration and its own student body are divided by exactly this failure of cooperation. 89% of students voted for divestment. Management refused. Cooperation, apparently, means something different when the institution is on one side and its students on the other.



Ask: Is this festival itself an act of cooperation, or an act of reputation management?

WHAT TO ASK AT EVERY SESSION



LSE talks about saving the planet while holding £86 million in fossil fuel companies. Ask every speaker: does the institution hosting your talk reflect the principles behind it?

READ THE EVIDENCE

Assets in Apartheid (2024) and *Stakes in Settler Colonialism* (2025) are free, fully referenced, and available at lsepalestine.github.io. Both were produced here, by students and staff of this university.

Assets in Apartheid



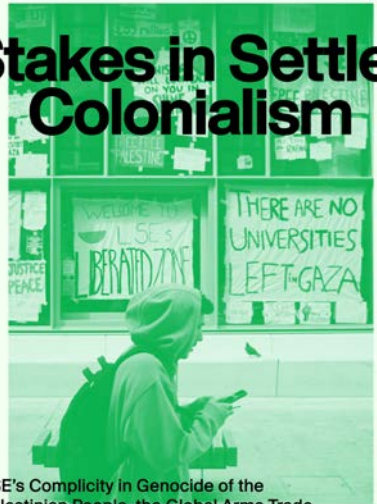
LSE's Complicity in Genocide of the Palestinian People, Arms Trade, and Climate Breakdown

LSESU Palestine Society – May 2024

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Stakes in Settler Colonialism



LSE's Complicity in Genocide of the Palestinian People, the Global Arms Trade, and Climate Breakdown

LSESU Palestine Society – June 2025

palestine@lsesu.org @ @lsepalestine



WHAT A GENUINE “SAVE THE PLANET” PROGRAMME WOULD ANNOUNCE

- 1. Full divestment from all holdings in fossil fuel companies,** and from the asset managers and advisors financing their expansion.
- 2. Immediate divestment from all companies identified in Assets in Apartheid and Stakes in Settler Colonialism** as complicit in crimes against the Palestinian people.
- 3. Full transparency of LSE’s portfolio.** Easy access to view how much money is invested and in which companies.
- 4. Democratic oversight of the endowment.** Students and staff must have binding participation in investment decisions.
- 5. An end to the BP Centennial Professorship** and all partnerships with BP and other fossil fuel giants.

Until these demands are met, every “How to Save the Planet” panel is an alibi for inaction.

*Programme compiled by
LSE Students for Justice in Palestine (SJP).*

